# SEO Changelog: How Deep Is the Water at Crab Island?

URL: https://crabislandtikitoursdestin.com/about-crab-island/how-deep-is-crab-island/ | WP page ID 790 (block content) | Last modified July 27, 2026 | Audit date: October 28, 2026 | Page 11 of the site queue

Method: content, headings, links, images and SEO meta were pulled from WordPress through the site connector. Template issues A to G (see the What Is Crab Island changelog) apply. This page does not have the broken charter link; it links to /about/ instead.

## 1. Summary

| Item | Current state |
|---|---|
| Role | Answers "how deep is crab island", "can you stand at crab island" and safety questions from parents. Safety content, so accuracy matters more than usual. |
| SEO title | How Deep Is the Water at Crab Island? Tides & Safety (52 characters, good) |
| Meta description | 143 characters, no price. Keep. |
| Body copy | About 1,900 words. Practical, specific advice (reading water color, watching drift). Some tide numbers don't agree with each other. |
| Headings | Three empty H2s after Key Takeaways; infographic placed inside an H2. |
| Internal links | 1 body link (/about/). No link to the charter page or to the blog post on tides. |
| Overlap | Blog post 924 "High Tide vs Low Tide at Crab Island" covers the same tide question. |

## 2. Critical fixes

| # | Issue | Fix |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | P1 Tide numbers disagree | Text says tide shifts depth "about a foot to a foot and a half". The tide table ranges from 1 to 2.5 feet at low tide up to 3 to 4.5 feet at high tide, which implies about 2 feet of swing, and 4.5 feet goes past the "2 to 4 feet" headline. Pick one set of numbers. Check the swing against the NOAA Tides & Currents station nearest the East Pass and cite it. Then make the table, the Key Takeaways and the FAQ match, plus blog post 924. |
| 2 | P1 Three empty H2s, infographic inside an H2 | Delete the empty H2s. Move the infographic into an Image block. |
| 3 | P1 Lead image too small to read | The lead image (alt "How deep is the water at Crab Island Infographic") shows at 300×281. If it really is a depth infographic, display it at full width (960 px) so the numbers can be read, and put the same numbers in text. If it isn't an infographic, fix the alt. The Home page uses this same file with this alt, so the answer fixes both pages. |

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| 4 | P1 Overlap with post 924 | Keep this page as the main depth answer. Keep post 924 focused on timing a trip around tides. Link them to each other with clear anchors (section 6) and make their numbers identical. |
| 5 | P2 Template items | "$900" (twice), plain-text phone, footer self-link, FAQ markup. |

## 3. SEO title and meta description

| Field | Current | New |
|---|---|---|
| SEO title | How Deep Is the Water at Crab Island? Tides & Safety | Keep. |
| Meta description | How deep is the water at Crab Island? Roughly 2 to 4 feet at typical tide. Tide effects, drop-offs, and why it works for kids and non-swimmers. | Keep. |
| Focus keyword | Primary: **how deep is crab island**. Secondary: can you stand at crab island, crab island depth, crab island water depth low tide, is crab island safe for non swimmers. | |

## 4. Heading structure

### Current

```
H1  How Deep Is the Water at Crab Island?
H2  Key Takeaways
H2  (empty) x3
H2  What 2 to 4 Feet Actually Feels Like
H2  How Tide Changes the Numbers
H2  The Drop-Offs Nobody Warns You About
H2  (infographic image)
H2  Current at the Sandbar
H2  Reading the Sandbar Before You Get In
H2  How Depth Shapes What Your Group Can Do
H2  Is It Safe for Non-Swimmers?
H2  What This Means for Your Trip
H2  Frequently Asked Questions
  H3  x5
H2  Anchor in the Right Spot
H2  More Crab Island Questions Answered
```

### New

```
H1  How Deep Is the Water at Crab Island?
H2  Key Takeaways
H2  What 2 to 4 Feet Feels Like
H2  Crab Island Depth at Low, Mid and High Tide
H2  Drop-Offs at the Channel Edge
H2  Current and Wind at the Sandbar
H2  How to Read the Sandbar Before You Get In
  H3  Water Color
  H3  Other Boats
  H3  Drifting Floats
H2  What You Can (and Can't) Do in Shallow Water
```

```
H2  Is Crab Island Safe for Non-Swimmers and Kids?
H2  Crab Island Depth FAQs
  H3  x5 existing + 1 new
H2  Anchor in the Right Spot
H2  More Crab Island Questions Answered
```

Fold "What This Means for Your Trip" into the final CTA. It repeats points already made and carries the disputed $900 price.

## 5. Content rewrites (paste-ready)

### Key Takeaways (revised tide bullet)

> - Tide changes the depth by about *(confirmed figure)* between low and high water. Check the day's tide before you go.

### H2: Crab Island Depth at Low, Mid and High Tide (table template)

| Tide stage | Typical sandbar depth | What it means |
|---|---|---|
| Low tide | *confirm* | Widest walkable area, easiest for small kids |
| Mid tide | *confirm* | Best all-around balance |
| High tide | *confirm* | Better for floating, deeper on children |

> Depths vary with exact position and with wind pushing water into or out of the bay. Source: *NOAA Tides & Currents, (station name)*, and our captain's depth readings at the spots we anchor. For planning a trip around the tide, see high tide vs low tide at Crab Island.

### New FAQ

> **Is Crab Island deep enough to swim?** Not really. At 2 to 4 feet, most people stand, wade and float. Deeper water is near the channel edge, where current is stronger, so don't swim out there. Diving off the boat is not allowed on our charters.

### Wording fixes

- "This is where a captain earns the fee." Keep. It's direct and persuasive.
- "You cannot recreate this experience at a beach or a marina." Fine as an opinion, but trim with the merged section.
- "Our 32-foot tiki boat draws shallow enough to anchor in the good spots" belongs in the final CTA. Remove the $900 price from the same paragraph.

## 6. Internal linking

| Anchor text | Target | Placement |
|---|---|---|

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| high tide vs low tide at Crab Island | /high-tide-vs-low-tide-at-crab-island/ | Tide section |
| Is Crab Island family friendly? | /is-crab-island-family-friendly/ | Non-swimmers section |
| private Crab Island charter | /charters/private-crab-island-charter-destin/ | Final CTA (currently missing) |
| Morning trips get the clearest water | /about-crab-island/best-time-to-visit-crab-island/ | What You Can Do |
| Water shoes still help | /about-crab-island/what-to-bring-to-crab-island/ | Non-swimmers section |
| a first-time renter guessing at depth | /about-crab-island/tiki-boat-vs-pontoon-rental-crab-island/ | Final CTA |
| under the Marler Bridge | /about-crab-island/where-is-crab-island/ | Current section |
| bachelorette groups | /crab-island-bachelorette-party-destin/ | What You Can Do |
| meet our captain | /captain-bill/ | Drop-offs section (replaces generic /about/ link) |

Inbound: post 924 and post 585 should both link here with anchor "how deep the water is at Crab Island". The Home page "Plan Your Trip" block already includes this page.

## 7. Images

| File | Current alt | Action |
|---|---|---|
| Crab-island-random-pic-Large-e1782787597533-300×281.png | How deep is the water at Crab Island Infographic | See critical fix 3. Rename to crab-island-depth-infographic.webp if it is the infographic. |
| Crab-Island-Tiki-Boat-Rental.png | Crab Island Tiki Boat Rental Infographic | Move out of H2 (template F). |

Ideal addition: a simple diagram of the sandbar showing shallow flats, the channel edge and the drop-off, or a photo of the color line between turquoise shallows and green channel. Set a featured image.

## 8. Technical

| # | Item | Action |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | P1 Empty headings | See critical fix 2. |
| 2 | P2 Schema | Article (with author and dateModified) and FAQPage. |
| 3 | P2 Source citation | An outbound link to NOAA Tides & Currents supports the depth and tide claims. Safety-related pages get more scrutiny from Google's quality guidelines, so cited sources help. |

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| 4 | P3 Breadcrumbs | Home > About Crab Island > How Deep Is Crab Island. |

## 9. Tracking

| Event | Setup |
|---|---|
| guide_click | Clicks to the tide post and family post, to see how often depth readers go on to safety content. |
| book_now_click / phone_click | `guide_name=how_deep`. |
| Search Console | Track "how deep is crab island" and "can you stand at crab island". This page and post 924 should not both rank for the same tide queries. If they do, tighten post 924's focus. |

## 10. Changelog

| # | Area | Change | Priority | Status |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Content | Make tide swing, table and FAQ agree; cite NOAA; match post 924 | P1 | To do |
| 2 | Headings | Delete 3 empty H2s; move infographic out of H2; new outline with reading-the-sandbar H3s | P1 | To do |
| 3 | Images | Confirm lead image is the depth infographic; show full size or fix alt (also on Home) | P1 | To do |
| 4 | Links | Add charter link and 8 contextual links; cross-link with post 924 | P1 | To do |
| 5 | Template | Remove $900, tel: link, footer self-link, FAQ block | P1 | To do |
| 6 | Content | New "deep enough to swim?" FAQ; merge "What This Means" into CTA | P2 | To do |
| 7 | Images | Sandbar diagram or color-line photo; featured image | P2 | To do |
| 8 | Technical | Article and FAQPage schema, NOAA citation, breadcrumbs | P2 | To do |
| 9 | Tracking | guide_click and guide_name; watch overlap with post 924 | P3 | To do |